

EU car lobby reaches position on IAA

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【要点】

- ・ EUの自動車業界団体AECAが産業加速化法（IAA）に関する統一見解に到達したが、「Made in Europe」の対象国をめぐる依然として深刻な意見対立が存在している。
- ・ IAAはEUの脱工業化を防ぎ、中国との競争で雇用喪失と工場閉鎖に直面する自動車産業を保護するため、公的資金を受ける電池と車両に対するヨーロッパ製購入要件を設定する制度である。
- ・ 英国がEUのIAA対象国に含まれていないことが問題となっており、AECAは英国の包含を要望しているが、英国が2024年のEU対中関税に追随しなかったため、中国製EVが英国で流入している状況が複雑性を増している。
- ・ ヨーロッパの自動車メーカーはモロッコやトルコなど低コスト地域に製造施設を設置しており、各社で異なるサプライチェーンを持つため、統一された基準の設定が困難になっている。

【メール原文】

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SNEAK PEEK

—The European auto lobby has negotiated a joint position among its automakers on the IAA but there are still deep disagreements over which countries should qualify.

— The European Parliament’s lead lawmaker on the Cybersecurity Act wants Brussels to extend its crackdown on high-risk technology suppliers well beyond telecoms — putting port assets in the firing line.

— Brussels’ plan to add two Indian “beaching” yards to the EU’s approved ship-recycling list is opening up a fight between lawmakers and the shipping industry over whether the facilities really meet Europe’s environmental and safety standards.

Good morning, and welcome to Morning Mobility.

Mark your calendars: Our weekly mobility calendar landed in your inbox on Thursday. You can also go online to export and plan your week or suggest your own event .

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DRIVING THE DAY

EXCLUSIVE — CAR LOBBY COMES TO JOINT POSITION ON IAA: After months of discussions and negotiations over competing strategies, the EU car lobby ACEA has a position on the Industrial Accelerator Act that it is putting forward to lawmakers. But big questions remain over the thorniest topic dividing the bloc's automakers: Which countries qualify as "Made in Europe?"

Back up: The IAA is the EU's solution to stop deindustrialization and to protect an automotive sector that is bleeding jobs and shuttering factories in the face of rising competition from China. The proposed legislation would set Buy European requirements for batteries and vehicles that receive public money, whether through public procurement or subsidies.

Problem No. 1: The U.K. is not included in the countries under the "Made in Europe" umbrella. With roughly 60% of automotive exports from the U.K. destined for the EU, that has automakers on both sides of the channel worried. ACEA wants the U.K. to be included in the scheme, the association told Jordyn on Thursday.

But, but, but: The U.K. failed to follow suit after the EU slapped duties on made-in-China electric vehicles in 2024. Chinese automakers then rerouted cars to the U.K. where they accounted for 15 percent of all sales in the first half of this year. Brussels may put pressure on the U.K. to impose new tariffs on the Chinese cars in exchange for being included in the IAA, a senior executive at Nissan told reporters earlier this week .

Problem No. 2: European automakers have global supply chains, and some have set up manufacturing in cheaper locales, such as Morocco or Turkey. But no automaker has the same supply chain, making it nearly impossible for them to come to a joint stance on which countries should be in and which should be out.

A compromise: Instead of advocating for certain countries, ACEA is lobbying for previous investments to be protected and classified as "Made in Europe."

Problem No. 3: One aim of the IAA is to create clean technology supply chains and demand across the EU, including for batteries to power electric vehicles. Upon adoption, three main battery components, including battery cells, must be made in Europe. After three years, this increases to five components.

Delay, please: Rather than coming into force upon adoption, ACEA wants the first battery requirements to go into effect after three years with the expanded requirements delayed to five years.

Time is of the essence: MEPs in the European Parliament have until Sept. 30 to submit amendments to the file after the three co-leads submitted their own report earlier this month.

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PORTS

PORTS ENTER THE HUAWEI-STYLE SECURITY FIGHT: The European Parliament's lead lawmaker on the Cybersecurity Act wants Brussels to extend its crackdown on high-risk technology suppliers well beyond telecoms — explicitly putting port cranes, cargo-handling systems, security scanners and logistics data platforms in the firing line.

Priority assets list: In amendments obtained by our colleague Sam Clark, rapporteur Markéta Gregorová proposes a new list of priority assets that the Commission would have to assess within 12 months of the law entering into force. Under the transport and logistics section, that includes automated cargo-handling and port-logistics equipment, ship-to-shore and yard cranes and their control and remote-diagnostic systems, security screening equipment at ports, and logistics platforms aggregating EU port, cargo or freight flows.

The point is not simply cybersecurity paperwork. Once assets are assessed as critical, the new framework could ultimately lead to restrictions on components supplied by companies deemed high-risk — potentially forcing ports to replace equipment or cut suppliers' remote access to key systems. Gregorová also proposes allowing restrictions on high-risk vendors' remote access for software updates, maintenance or configuration unless that access is controlled by the operator.

Crane politics: That matters because modern container terminals rely heavily on connected and remotely managed equipment. The separate annex circulated with the amendments specifically singles out ship-to-shore cranes and their control systems as priority infrastructure for security assessment.

Not just ports: The same annex also targets connected control and fleet-management systems used in electric buses and rail rolling stock, as well as unmanned aircraft systems and their flight-control and data platforms when used by critical entities. That means the security review could eventually touch public transport fleets, rail systems and drones, as well as maritime logistics.

EV infrastructure, too: In a separate energy category, Gregorová also includes power-conversion and management systems for electric-vehicle charging infrastructure, suggesting the supply-chain security push could extend into another corner of transport infrastructure.

Who pays? Gregorová is also proposing compensation where mandatory removal of high-risk technology would impose a "disproportionate burden." Her text says governments could compensate affected operators based on factors such as the remaining depreciation period and the length of the phase-out, while replacement of key assets could also qualify for EU support through programs including the Connecting Europe Facility and Digital Europe.

Not done yet: These are the rapporteur's amendments, not Parliament's final position. But they show that the Huawei debate is quickly becoming a much broader transport-infrastructure fight — with ports potentially next in line after telecoms.

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****A message from BMW Group:** Under current rules, two electric vehicles may both be zero-emissions, yet have very different carbon footprints. If Europe wants to reduce carbon dioxide as effectively as

possible, every ton saved should count. BMW Group's Dr. Frank Niederländer explains why Europe needs to look beyond the tailpipe. Read the interview with POLITICO Studio here .**

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MARITIME

SHIP TO SHORE: Brussels' plan to add two Indian "beaching" yards to the EU's approved ship-recycling list is opening up a fight between lawmakers and the shipping industry over whether the facilities really meet Europe's environmental and safety standards.

MEPs push back: A cross-party group of lawmakers from the Greens, S&D, Renew and the Left wrote to Commissioners Jessika Roswall and Stéphane Séjourné urging the Commission to drop the two Indian shipyards from the proposed 16th edition of the European list, according to a letter obtained by our colleague Jakob Weizman. Their core argument is that yards built on an intertidal beach cannot meet the Ship Recycling Regulation requirement to be "designed, constructed AND operated in a safe and environmentally sound manner."

Waste concerns, too: The MEPs also point to inspection reports saying the downstream incinerator used by the yards does not meet standards broadly equivalent to EU limits for pollutants including dust, SO₂, HCl, HF and total carbon. They argue the Commission has not yet shown that all downstream waste facilities meet equivalent EU standards either.

Industry hits back: Shipping groups including BIMCO, CLIA, ECSA, ICS, Intercargo, Interferry, Intertanko and the World Shipping Council moved Thursday with an open letter urging EU governments to approve the two yards. They argue the facilities have invested heavily in infrastructure, safety systems and environmental management and that publicly available inspections show they meet the EU's own requirements.

Capacity fight: The two sides also disagree over whether Europe needs the extra recycling capacity. The shipping industry says more vessels are nearing end-of-life and that adding compliant non-OECD yards is necessary to secure sufficient capacity. The MEPs counter that European recycling yards already have enough capacity for the EU-flagged fleet but are operating at only around 20-25% because of competition from South Asian beaching yards.

What's next: The issue goes to member countries in the Ship Recycling Regulation Committee on Sept. 21, when governments are expected to discuss the Commission proposal.

CARS

THE END OF THE GLOBAL CAR: Volvo laid out its strategy to media and investors on Thursday, giving an epitaph to globalization and the idea that manufacturers could produce one vehicle to sell in all markets around the world. "It worked some years ago. It's not going to work in the future," CEO Håkan Samuelsson said.

Cybersecurity concerns: One reason for this is stricter cybersecurity regulations as cars now more closely resemble a computer than the vehicles from two decades ago. Citing national security risks, the U.S. has essentially banned Chinese connected cars from its market and American policymakers want to go further in banning Chinese parts and software.

An exception: The Chinese behemoth Geely bought Volvo in 2010, meaning the Swedish automaker is also caught up in the rules. But it secured an exception with the Trump administration. "There we have introduced an absolute firewall," Samuelsson said.

Closer integration: Geely and Volvo are becoming more closely intertwined, even as Volvo creates a strategy for China and the rest of the world. A leader in EVs, Geely will be supplying some technologies and components to Volvo. But the biggest development is that Volvo is opening its Gent factory to other brands, including Geely, for contract manufacturing, the company announced.

PIT STOPS

Airports across Poland suspended flights after Russian drone strikes near the country's border with Ukraine.

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****A message from BMW Group: Europe's automotive industry is entering a crucial decade. As manufacturers navigate electrification, global competition, geopolitical uncertainty and rising energy costs, Europe faces the challenge of delivering decarbonization while strengthening competitiveness and resilience. In this Q&A , POLITICO Studio speaks to Dr. Frank Niederländer, Vice President for Government Affairs Europe at BMW Group, about the choices and conditions that will shape the next phase of Europe's automotive transition. He discusses how Europe can strengthen the industrial base behind the transition, what it will take to build a competitive battery ecosystem and why establishing new capabilities requires the right investment conditions — and time to scale. He also explores why policymakers should look beyond tailpipe emissions to consider the full value chain, and the potential role of renewable fuels alongside electrification. And why the transition will only succeed if it works for consumers and businesses while keeping investment, innovation and value creation in Europe.****

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Headlines

Here's a recap of yesterday's news, along with Pro articles and alerts from overnight.

Commission trade chief to travel to China on Oct. 8-9

Visit comes a week before EU leaders review whether negotiations alone will be enough to rebalance the bloc's €1-billion-a-day trade deficit with China.

By Carlo Martuscelli · Sept 17, 2026, 04:30 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

Russia hunts Ukraine's trains

The escalating campaign is destroying up to 40 locomotives a month and exposing Ukraine's urgent replacement gap.

By Veronika Melkozerova · Sept 17, 2026, 04:25 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

EU auto suppliers losing ground to China

By Jordyn Dahl · Sept 17, 2026, 10:59 am Europe/Brussels CEST

Trump hit America's allies on trade. Now he wants their help on Chinese steel.

Reviving a Biden-era effort, the Trump administration wants its allies to link arms on steel market protections to keep out surplus Chinese production.

By Koen Verhelst, Oliver Ward, Stefanie Bolzen · Sept 17, 2026, 07:47 am Europe/Brussels CEST

Weekly Calendar

Here's a selection of upcoming key events, find the complete Week Ahead online.

Pro Roundtable – Financial Services UK

Sep 22, 2026, 9:00 AM - 11:00 am

Brussels Playbook Live 2026

Sep 22, 2026, 1:30 PM - 6:00 pm

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Brussels Playbook Live 2026

Sep 22, 2026, 1:30 PM - 6:00 pm

POLITICO Back to School Party 2026

Sep 22, 2026, 4:00 PM - 6:00 pm

Commission 'EU Access to Space' conference

Sep 23, 2026 · Brussels, BE

IATA Cargo Experts Conference

Sep 23, 2026 - Sep 24, 2026 · Budapest, HU

European Commission 'EU Access to Space Conference'

Sep 23, 2026 · Brussels, BE

Coreper II

Sep 23, 2026 · Brussels, BE

Coreper I

Sep 23, 2026 · Brussels, BE

Council Working Party on Land Transport

Sep 23, 2026 · Brussels, BE

Council Working Party on Aviation

Sep 23, 2026 · Brussels, BE

Council Working Party on Transport — Intermodal Questions and Networks

Sep 24, 2026 · Brussels, BE

Pro Roundtable – Defense

Sep 24, 2026, 8:15 AM - 9:45 am

Pro Roundtable – Trade UK

Sep 24, 2026, 9:00 AM - 11:00 am

Playbook Paris Live 2026

Sep 24, 2026, 1:30 PM - 5:20 pm

POLITICO Soirée de Rentrée 2026

Sep 24, 2026, 2:00 PM - 5:00 pm

The POLITICO Pub at the Labour Party Conference

Sep 27, 2026, 9:00 AM - Sep 29, 2026, 5:00 PM

Pro Intelligence Connections

2017/0225(COD) EU Cybersecurity Agency (ENISA) and...

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